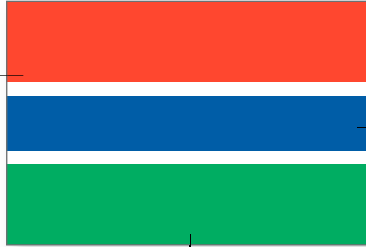


Gambia

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** February 18, 1965 **Usage:** National and Civil

*Red represents
the savannah
grasslands*



*The blue stripe
symbolizes the
River Gambia*

*Green symbolizes
the forests*

Africa



The **Gambia** became self-governing in 1963 and fully independent of Britain on February 18, 1965. It became a republic on April 24, 1970.

The flag of Gambia has no political basis. The blue stripe of the flag is said to represent the River Gambia flowing between the green forest and the red savannah. It was adopted at independence in 1965.

The coat of arms was granted before independence, in 1964. It makes no reference to the previous

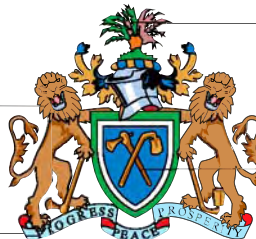
colonial badge of the Gambia and follows traditional heraldry. The two tools represent the main ethnic groups—the Mandinka and the Fulani—and the crest, above the helmet, is a local oil palm.

The federation formed with Senegal from 1981–1989 had no effect on the national symbols.

ARMS OF GAMBIA

*The supporters are two
lions, shown holding tools*

*The national motto—
“Progress, Peace, Prosperity”*



*A crest of oil
palm leaves*

*An ax and a hoe represent
the Mandinka and the
Fulani, the two main ethnic
groups in Gambia*